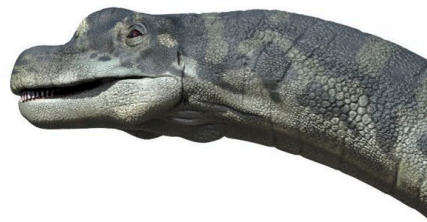


Sizing them up

Dinosaurs have a reputation for being the biggest and fiercest creatures ever to inhabit this planet. While it is true that many were larger than a house, some were as small as a chicken. Scientific research has revealed the incredible range of sizes of these reptiles, and how each of the dinosaurs measured up.



Triceratops

Even though Triceratops was an average-sized dinosaur, it was still as long as two cars.

Sinosauropteryx

This little carnivore was a fast hunter, running on two feet. Sinosauropteryx grew to just 3 ft (1 m) long, which is about twice the size of a cat.



How do we know?

Dinosaurs died out 66 million years ago, so how do we know so much about them? Fortunately, scientists have found lots of dinosaur fossils, mainly of their bones. By examining their preserved bones and the tracks they left behind, experts can tell how large a dinosaur was, what it ate, how it lived, and even how it may have died.



95 million-year-old dinosaur bones

Looking at bones

Dinosaur experts take their finds back to the laboratory to find out more about them. The bones shown here are from a sauropod, a group of long-necked dinosaurs that were some of the biggest to ever walk the Earth.